



Mayor of outer space

A NASA astronaut has become the first person to check in to Foursquare from outer space. Pointless? Yes. Fun? Totally

Rails for zombies

Learn Ruby and Rails from the comfort of your browser with Rails for Zombies. <http://railsforzombies.org/>

to see this), assembled PCs have the highest score when it comes to index of ownership, this covers satisfaction of use, and costs involved with maintenance. This is heartening for those who believe in assembled desktops,

and it's clear that the costs including maintenance, associated with assembling a PC are lower, or rather, our readers perceive it to be so.

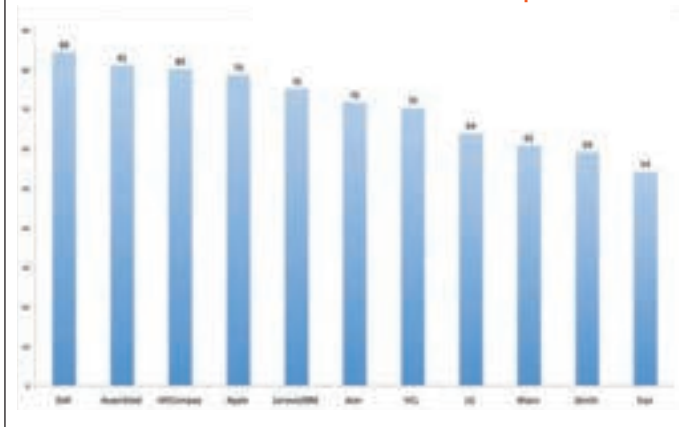
- Dell has extended their lead ever so slightly over HP/Compaq over last year. Assembled desktops have also built up a lead on everyone else, and they're pretty close to the two leaders. Lenovo has lost ground, and Apple's lead has grown enough for them to overtake Lenovo and take the fourth position.

The most trusted

So who do our readers trust when it comes to manufacturers of desktop PCs, and brands in general? Dell has become almost a household name in this country, and in a relatively short period of time.

And before you stand up and protest, where was Dell five years ago? Most people bought Dell systems from abroad and imported them here. Dell leads even in the notebook segment, and this is testament to some really smart marketing, and some really sweet products. HP/Compaq is a veritable giant in India, (globally too), and they're not going to give up the second spot without a fight. A huge marketing outlay, and a well established distribution network has helped them retain the number two spot. The third spot is occupied collectively by small vendors – the assembled desktops leave other brands like Lenovo, Acer and HCL in the dust.

Trust index - Desktop PC



Laptops and netbooks

With the exception of cellphones, no other consumer electronics device garners as much attention and interest as a notebook. Notebooks have become specialised pieces of equipment. Just visit a showroom, and you'll see what we're talking about. They come in all sizes, configurations and are intended for specific, albeit different purposes. Even the latest darlings, i.e. netbooks are basically no frills notebooks with lower performance components, and a smaller, cheaper-to-build chassis. From the 18.6-inch monsters to the ultra compact 12.1-inch powerhouses, there is a huge user base for notebooks. And there is a huge variety in brands too, as well as the products they offer. No wonder then, that our tech community had so much to say.

Market Trends

The revolution of netbooks has come and gone. Netbooks are no longer a new product line, but they continue to gather a fan base. And with good reason, prices have fallen slightly, and more and more vendors are offering additional goodies like 3G SIM card support, a better finish and keypads, and dual core Atom proces-

sors. Windows 7 is also lighter than Vista on system resources, and with 2 GB inside your netbook, you can enjoy a very nice computing experience.

Meanwhile, we've seen the advent of Core i5/i7 processors inside notebooks. DX11 GPUs have brought about a shot in the arm to gaming notebooks. We're steadily seeing components get better, even as the market is splitting into two distinct parts – those who want a desktop replacement, and those who want portability.

Perceptions from our survey

- Dell and HP (in that order) is what is recalled when we ask them impromptu to blurt out the first notebook brand that comes to mind. Kudos to Dell, they don't even have a very strong retail presence in India, and most of the recall is on the basis of reputation, word of mouth, and of course advertisements. HP is second here, while Sony is a distant third. Acer is fourth. The rest of the vendors have very small showings. Surprising that Apple got left out.
- Who do you trust? Dell is the answer. HP and Sony vie for third spot. Wait a minute, who's second? Apple surprises us garnering enough votes to slingshot them to second place.
- When talking about quality, Apple overtakes Dell. We're surprised too. But evidently, Apple is perceived as a costly, although very solid and long lasting. Could it be all that aluminium is being perceived as being very solid? Although, Macbooks reportedly fail less often than Windows-based notebooks, we feel Apple's campaign to use metal paid off here. If it's perceived

Trust index - Laptops and Notebook

